On the other hand, there are people responsible for day-to-day data operations. In some cases, they may be called data stewards (or domain data stewards); sometimes this role will be performed by product owners who are responsible for developing IT systems. For example, in a data mesh, this function is carried out by data product owners.

This chapter describes how responsibilities for various layers of data governance can be distributed.

6.4.1 Thinking of data governance in terms of "sliders"

The two extremes of data governance are the centralized operating model and decentralized operating model. The former assumes full decision-making capability in the hands of a central governing body, with respective teams left with just the implementation of decided solutions. On the other hand, the latter often does not even allow the existence of a central governing body, shifting the full responsibility for data operations aspects to developers.

The *federated model* aims to find a balance between the long-term perspective and big-picture view offered by the central governance body, and the dynamics and flexibility of development ensured by a high level of autonomy of empowered product owners.

There is no one-size-fits-all solution. Depending on the specifics of your organization, different centralization levels may be optimal. However, there is no need to overcomplicate things by trying to split responsibilities case by case for each product owner. Previously, figure 6.3 presented the hierarchical structure of data governance layers. Figure 6.4 represents further generalization of this idea, with vertical "sliders" dividing the responsibilities for different levels of governance.